

ALIGARH

A Brief on the city:

Aligarh is a District of Uttar Pradesh, India. The city is located about 90 miles (140 km) southeast of New Delhi. The administrative headquarters of Aligarh District is Aligarh (Koil). It is also commissionerary HQ for all four Districts Aligarh itself, Hathras, Kasganj and Etah. It is mostly known as a university town where the famous Aligarh Muslim University is located. It is also well known District internationally because of its lock industries.

2. Education:

Major Central/ State Universities in Aligarh comprises of Aligarh Muslim University (1875).

In 1875, Sir Syed Ahmed Khan founded the Muhammadan Anglo Oriental College in Aligarh and patterned the college after Oxford and Cambridge universities that he had visited on a trip to England. This later became **Aligarh Muslim University in 1920.**

3. Culture and Tourism:

Before the 18th century Aligarh was known by the name of Kol or Koil. This city of Uttar Pradesh is famous for its rich legacy, heritage and culture. Visited by many tourists every year Aligarh is a commercial, educational and industrial hub in India. This city has a distinct personality due to the fusion of historical and geographical elements.

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HISSAR

A Brief on the city:

Also known as 'The Steel City' of India, Hisar is in Indian state of Haryana. With an elaborated history that is associated to the city, Hisar also is an important part of modern India. Encompassing the remains and traces of Pre-Harappan Civilization and Harappan Civilizations, Hisar is India's largest site showcasing the life of earliest settlements of the humans.

The present city of Hisar, one of the important cities of North India. It is situated one hundred sixty four kilometers west to Delhi on the National Highway number ten.

2. Education:

Major Central/ State Universities in Hisar comprises of Chaudhary Charan Singh Haryana Agriculture University, Hisar.

3. Culture and Tourism:

Culture of a place is a reflection of its society. The culture of Hisar is fascinating and captivating. It tells us about the people of the place, their lifestyle and their beliefs. Observing the culture of Hisar gives you a fair idea about the traditions and practices that are still followed by the locals. The festivals, the events, the attractions, all reflect the culture of Hisar in one way or the other.

The construction work of the Hisar city started in the year 1354 A.D. under the personal supervision of Firozshah himself who stayed here for a sufficient time. The boundary wall of Hisar Firoza was built of stones brought from the hills of Narsai. The fort city was also surrounded by a big ditch dug round the wall. The palace, popularly known as 'Gujari Mahal', was made for his beloved. The Gujari Mahal still stands in its austere majesty. This palace is a complex of different buildings, including the royal residence of the sultan Firozshah, Shahi Darwaza, Diwan-e-Aam, Baradari with three tehkhanas, a Hamam, a mosque and a pillar.

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PUNE

A Brief on the city:

Pune is the second largest district in the state of Maharashtra.

2. Education:

Major Central/ State Universities in Pune comprises of **Savitribai Phule Pune University**, one of the premier universities in India.

3. Culture and Tourism:

Pune exemplifies an indigenous Marathi culture and ethos, in which education, arts and crafts, and theatres are given due prominence. Pune is the seat of North Indian Classical music. Annually, in the month of December, it hosts a three nightlong cultural program of vocal and instrumental classical music, called "Savai-Gandharva". Pune has been an example for the blending of the culture and heritage with modernisation and its side effects. Pune is the cultural capital of the Maharashtra.

The Lokmanya Tilak Museum at Tilak Wada which used to be the great nationalist leader Bal Gangadhar Tilak's home. A few minutes from here is the Shaniwar Wada, a fort that used to be seat of the Peshwa rulers of the Maratha Empire. Next is Lal Mahal which was built by Shivaji's father Shahaji Bhonsle for his wife Jijabai. It was here that the great Maratha warrior spent his formative years.

The other places of interest includes Mahatma Jyotirao Phule's cottage, the Kelkar Museum, the Chaturshringi Temple and the Ambedkar Museum. The serene and colourful Pune Okayama Friendship Garden, sprawling Rajiv Gandhi Zoological Park and the Shinde Chhatri Temple, the Aga Khan Palace etc.

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VARANASI

A Brief on the city:

Varanasi, or Benaras, (also known as Kashi) is one of the oldest living cities in the world. Varanasi's Prominence in Hindu mythology is virtually unrevealed.

2. Education:

Major Central/ State Universities in Varanasi comprises of Banaras Hindu University, Mahatam Gandhi Kashi Vidyapeeth, Sampurnanand Sanskrit Vishwavidyalaya.

3. Culture and Tourism:

The art and culture of Varanasi is unique. It is the rich cultural tradition of Varanasi that makes it the cultural capital of India. A combination of archaeology, mythology, geography, art and history makes Varanasi a great center of Indian culture.

The Ganga Ghats (river front) are the most popular pilgrimage spot of Varanasi and are centers of music and learning. There is a great tradition of Yatras in the holy city of Kashi and the most sacred path is that of Panchkoshi Parikrama, the fifty-mile path with a radius of five miles that cover 108 shrines along the way, with Panchakoshi Temple as its main shrine. Other popular pilgrimage route is Nagara Pradakshina, which covers seventy-two shrines along the way. Since time immemorial Varanasi is a great center of learning.

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PATNA

A Brief on the city:

Patna is the capital and largest city of the state of Bihar in India. The Buddhist, Hindu, and Jain pilgrimage centres of Vaishali, Rajgir, Nalanda, Bodh Gaya, and Pawapuri are nearby and Patna City is also a sacred city for Sikhs as the tenth Sikh Guru, Guru Gobind Singh, was born here.

2. Education:

Major Central/ State Universities in Patna comprises of Central University of South Bihar, Patna University.

3. Culture and Tourism:

Patna is blessed with a culture which has continuously evolved during the last 2500 years of recorded history. The population comprises of different sects of people who came here over the centuries and finally settled down. The evolution and spread of religions like Buddhism, Jainism and Sikhism has added secular aspect to the city. The people from different regions of state also settled down in the city, bringing along with them culture, craft and language of the region specific, thus making the city as culturally vibrant.

The food of the city reflects the tradition brought along the history and its quite distinct. The *Mughlai* and Central Asia food, brought along with the foreign invaders during Medieval India can also be found in the city. Rice forms the staple food, eaten in combination with lentils, vegetables, chapati and pickles.

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MUMBAI

A Brief on the city:

Mumbai (formerly called Bombay) is a densely populated city on India's west coast. A financial center, it is India's largest city. Offshore, nearby Elephanta Island holds ancient cave temples dedicated to the Hindu god Shiva. The city is also famous as the heart of the Bollywood film industry.

2. Education:

Major Central/ State Universities in Mumbai comprises of Mumbai University, Mahatma Gandhi Antarrashtriya Hindi Vishwavidyalaya, IIT Bombay.

3. Culture and Tourism:

Mumbai is a magical city with a vibe that cannot be felt anywhere else. Housing India's most prolific film industry; some of Asia's biggest slums as well as world's most expensive homes along with the largest tropical forest in an urban area, the city truly mirrors the diversity that India is known for. Not only this, the city can fill pages after pages when it comes to rich history and it can give any place in the country a good run for money when it comes to nightlife. The bottomline is Mumbai is truly a place to see in India, something that will engage your memories for days after the tour as well. There is something for everyone and in enough quantity to blow one's mind up! Without further ado, let me share with you a list of top 35 places to visit in Mumbai, so in case you are planning a trip to this action packed city, you do not miss out even on one aspect of it.

Gateway of India is the major landmark of Mumbai City. Built in the 20th Century to commemorate the visit of King George V and Queen Mary to Mumbai.

Situated at a 10 km radius from Gateway of India is one of the major tourist places in Mumbai, the Elephanta Caves. The caves are said to be one of the oldest rock cut structures in the country and is a perfect example of archaic Indian art associated to the cult of Lord Shiva.

Probably one of the most visited places in Mumbai, Juhu Beach is situated in Ville Parle. Juhu Beach comes to life mostly in the evening, when people from all walks of life visit here to enjoy sunset, play in the water and treat their taste buds with street food like Bhel Puri and Pav Bhaji.

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LUCKNOW

A Brief on the city:

Lucknow, is the capital of the state of Uttar Pradesh. Toward its center is Rumi Darwaza, a Mughal gateway. Nearby, the 18th-century Bara Imambara shrine has a huge arched hall. Upstairs, Bhool Bhulaiya is a maze of narrow tunnels with city views from its upper balconies. Close by, the grand Victorian Husainabad Clock Tower was built as a victory column in 1881.

2. Education:

Major Central/ State Universities in Patna comprises of, Lucknow University, Babasaheb Bhimrao Ambedkar University, Dr. Ram Manohar Lohiya National Law University, Uttar Pradesh Technical University.

3. Culture and Tourism:

Lucknow, the capital of Uttar Pradesh, lies in the middle of the Heritage Arc. This bustling city, famed for its Nawabi era finesse and amazing food, is a unique mix of the ancient and the modern. It is home to extraordinary monuments depicting a fascinating blend of ancient, colonial and oriental architecture

Lucknow was the epicentre of the 1857 War of Independence, and much before that, it was the seat of a line of nawabs who gave the city its unique identity. Literature, cuisine, performing arts and tehzeeb put Lucknow a cut above the rest – and the world acknowledges it. Among the magnificent monuments are Imambara, Rumi Darwaza, Kaiserbagh Heritage Zone, Residency and Dilkusha.

Chikan embroidery and zardozi have made Lucknow a brand in global fashion.

Kebabs and Biryani are the two lip-smacking delicacies that beckon visitors again and again.

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KOLKATA

A Brief on the city:

Kolkata is the capital of India's West Bengal state. Today it's known for its grand colonial architecture, art galleries and cultural festivals. It's also home to Mother House, headquarters of the Missionaries of Charity, founded by Mother Teresa, whose tomb is on site.

2. Education:

Major Central/ State Universities in Kolkata comprises of **Visva-Bharati University** founded by the first Indian Nobel Laureate Rabindranath Tagore in 1921, Visva-Bharati was declared to be a central university and is an institution of national importance, **Jadavpur University** is at present an internationally recognised premier university of the country, Aliah University, Calcutta University, Presidency University, Rabindra Bharati University, The Sanskrit College and University, West Bengal State University, West Bengal University of Animal and Fishery Sciences, West Bengal University of Technology.

3. Culture and Tourism:

Kolkata is perhaps the most important cultural centre of India. The city is the birthplace of modern Indian literary and artistic thought and of Indian nationalism, and its citizens have made great efforts to preserve Indian culture and civilization. The blending of Eastern and Western cultural influences over the centuries has stimulated the creation of numerous and diverse organizations that contribute to Kolkata's cultural life.

Kolkata has a wealth of history engrained in its many monuments and landmarks, such as the Victoria Memorial. Kolkata boasts of some of the best seafood, street food and sweet options. You would love the different preparations of fish, rolls and sandesh. The centre of the Bengal Renaissance, Kolkata has always been a hotbed of literature, theatre, art and poetry. Home to traditional craftsmen and weavers, you can buy beautiful Calcutta sarees at very reasonable prices.

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JAMMU

A Brief on the city:

Jammu city is situated at the banks of the river Tawi. It is also the winter capital of the Jammu & Kashmir state. This is the region of the Middle Himalayas comprising several upland valleys of great natural beauty. The region of Jammu is not homogenous. It is broadly divisible into three discernible zones determined by the terrain condition and the geo-climatic environment.

2. Education:

Major Central/ State Universities in Patna comprises of **University of Jammu**:- The University of Jammu, accredited as 'A+' Grade University by National Assessment & Accreditation Council of India, **Central University of Jammu**.

3. Culture and Tourism:

Jammu region is home to several ethnic communities which follow traditional life-styles with distinctive cultures of their own

The Tourism is the largest industry in Jammu. Millions of devotees visit Jammu in connection with the holy pilgrimage to Mata Vaishno Devishrine and is also a base for the holy Amar Nathyatra. All the routes leading to Kashmir, Poonch, Doda, Bhaderwah, Katra and Laddakh start from Jammu city. The city witnesses tourists from various parts of the country throughout the year. The places of interest for sightseeing at Jammu include old historic places like Amar Mahal, Mubarak Mandi, Bahu Fort, Raghunath Temple, Ranbireshwar Temple, Peer Kho, Mahamaya temple and many more. Jammu has a large number of mosques, shrines, gurudwaras and churches as well. The city also has a number of shopping places, fun parks, etc.

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JAIPUR

A Brief on the city:

Jaipur is the capital of India's Rajasthan state. Known as the Pink City because of the colour of the stone used exclusively in the walled city.

2. Education:

Major Central/ State Universities in Patna comprises of Central University of Rajasthan, Dr. Bhimrao Ambedkar Law University, Jagadguru Ramanandacharya Sanskrit University, Rajasthan University.

3. Culture and Tourism:

Jaipur has been laid according to the conventional nine-grid pattern that astrologers believe to be lucky, and which has been recommended in the ancient Indian treatise on architecture. Each grid consists of a square, and these have been planned so that, at the heart of the city is the City Palace.

Jaipur architectural planning may have been ancient, but its execution was definitely modern. Best represented by the City Palace complex, it brought together all that was excellent in Rajput and Mughal architecture, creating a new tradition that found wide currency over much of north India. As in the Mughal tradition, the durbar or court areas became much more open, characterised by a series of arched pavilions held on delicately crafted pillars. Ornamentation had always been a part of the state architectural heritage.

Jaipur has much to offer visitors everything from pageants and festivals to extraordinarily clad people, a wealth of handicrafts, a royal legacy of palaces, and sightseeing that will occupy their time.

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